Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112B
Cultures II

Main - All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025/Fall Semester
Date:15 Jan. 2025
4:30 – 5:30

AOU EGYPT

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 3 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

This exam consists of TWO PARTS.

PART 1 contains 3 SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

PART 2 contains 3 ESSAY QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What are **'subgenres'** in literature, and how do they categorize literary works?
2. What is **'creative writing'**? What are its different types?
3. What is the **'Heroic Journey'** and how is it used in storytelling?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(40 points= 20 points for each essay)

Please choose TWO of the essay prompts below and write comprehensive responses in essay format. Your essays should be around 350 words each, covering all relevant aspects of the questions and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essays with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Explore the concept of the **hybrid novel** and discuss why ***Jane Eyre*** by Charlotte Brontë is considered an excellent example of this genre. Analyze the various subgenres incorporated into the novel and how they contribute to its hybrid nature. Consider such subgenres as **Gothic fiction**, **Bildungsroman**, **romance**, and **feminist fiction**.
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. What is a hybrid novel, and what characteristics define this genre?
   b. In what ways does ***Jane Eyre*** incorporate elements of Gothic fiction, and how do these elements affect the mood of the story?
   c. How does ***Jane Eyre*** fit the definition of a Bildungsroman, and what aspects of character growth does it explore?
   d. What romantic elements are present in the novel, and how do they shape Jane's relationships and experiences?
   e. How does Brontë use feminist themes in ***Jane Eyre***, and what messages does this convey about women's roles in society?
   f. In what ways does the blending of these subgenres enhance the story's complexity and depth, revealing insights about both Jane's character and broader social issues?

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5. Choose a **fictional or historical figure** you admire. Describe their appearance, personality, and contributions that shaped their legacy.
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. Who is the figure you admire?
   b. What does the figure look like, and how would you describe their style or appearance?
   c. What are some key traits of their personality, and how did these traits influence their actions?
   d. What significant contributions did this figure make, and how did they impact others?
   e. How did this figure's actions shape their legacy and how people remember them today?
   f. Why do you personally admire this figure, and what lessons can we learn from them?

6. In **'The Impossible Planet'** by Philip K. Dick, examine the five stages of the **dramatic arc – exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.** How do these stages unfold in the story, impacting the characters and the overall narrative structure, and what meaning or themes do they convey?
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. What happens in the exposition of 'The Impossible Planet,' and how does it introduce the main characters and setting?
   b. How does the rising action build tension and develop the plot leading up to the climax?
   c. What is the climax of the story, and why is it a turning point for the characters?
   d. How does the falling action resolve the conflicts and develop the story after the climax?
   e. What themes or messages emerge from the resolution, and how do the stages of the dramatic arc contribute to these ideas?

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End of the Exam!

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